

IAS PRELIMS/MAINS

Ecology & Environment

A stylized illustration of a green city skyline with various skyscrapers, wind turbines, and a sun, set against a light green background.

A COMPREHENSIVE COVERAGE

MODULE - 48

INTERNATIONAL ENVIRONMENTAL CONVENTIONS -1

INTERNATIONAL ENVIRONMENTAL CONVENTIONS

Sr. No.	CONVENTION	OUTCOME	
1	United Nations Conference on Human Environment 1972.	Stockholm Declaration and creation of UNEP.	
2	United Nations Conference on Environment and Development (UNCED) / Earth Summit / Rio Summit 1992.	LEGALLY BINDING	LEGALLY NON-BINDING
		1. Convention on Biological Diversity 2. The United Nations Framework convention on climate change (UNFCCC) 3. The United Nations convention to combat Desertification	1. Rio Declaration on Environment and Development 2. Agenda 21 3. Forest conservation principles

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CONVENTION ON BIOLOGICAL DIVERSITY

3 MAIN GOALS

1. Conservation of Biodiversity.
2. Sustainable use of Biodiversity.
3. Fair and equitable sharing of benefits arising out of the use of genetic resources.



OBJECTIVE

- To develop national strategies for the conservation and sustainable use of biodiversity.
- The convention recognized for the first time that conservation of biodiversity is a common concern of mankind and is an integral part of development.



1 CONVENTION ON BIOLOGICAL DIVERSITY

ISSUES DEALT BY THE CONVENTION

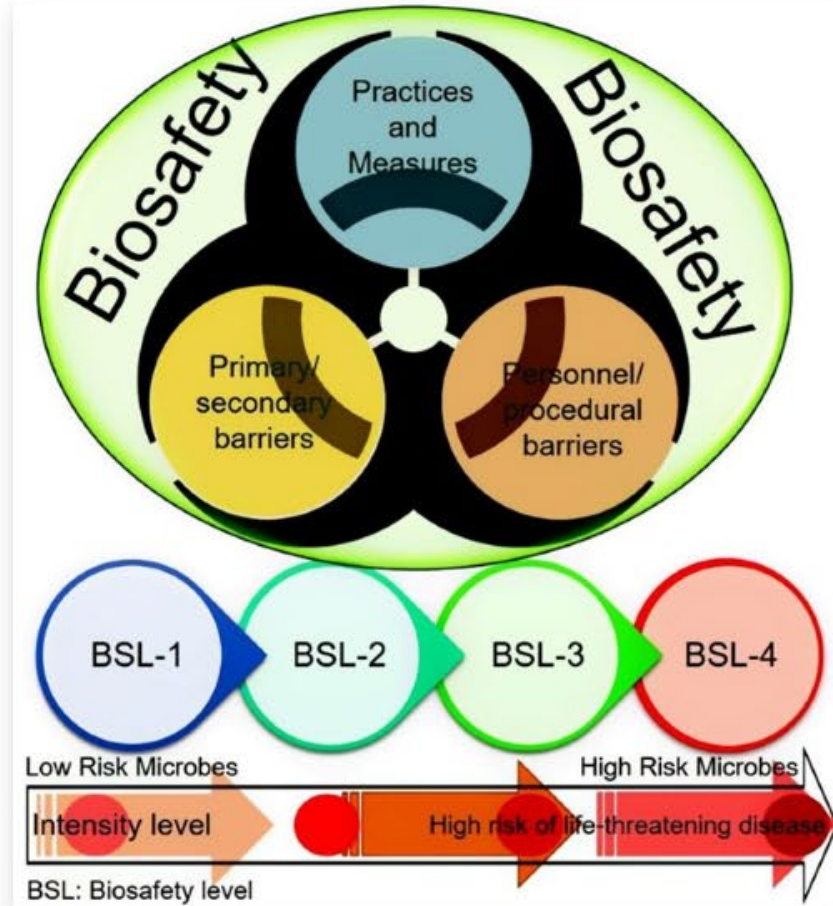
1. Measures for the conservation and sustainable use of biodiversity.
2. Regulated access to genetic resources and traditional knowledge.
3. Sharing in a fair and equitable way, the results of R&D and the benefits arising from the commercial use of genetic resources.
4. Access to and transfer of technology between the countries.
5. Technical and scientific cooperation.
6. Providing financial resources to developing and LDCs for conservation.
7. Subsidiary Body on Scientific, Technical and Technological Advice (SBSTTA) is established by the Convention to provide advice to COP.
8. The agreed text of CBD was adopted on May 22nd 1992, which is celebrated every year as 'The International Day of Biodiversity'.



1 CONVENTION ON BIOLOGICAL DIVERSITY

SCOPE

- The agreement covers all ecosystems, species and genetic resources.
- It sets principles for the fair and equitable sharing of benefits arising from the use of genetic resources.
- It also covers the field of biotechnology and bio-safety issues.
- The convention uses Precautionary Principle to guide decision makers, which states that 'When there is a threat of significant reduction or loss of biodiversity, lack of full scientific certainty should not be used as a reason for postponing measures to avoid or minimize threat.'



1 CONVENTION ON BIOLOGICAL DIVERSITY

GENETIC RESOURCES

- Traditionally farmers throughout the world have raised thousands of different animal breeds and plant varieties to increase yields and to better suit local conditions. This resulted in many different breeds or varieties which form a vast collection of genetic diversity.
- Genetic Resources is a term that represents this diversity. This diversity is essential for the adaptation of crops and animals to new diseases, changing climate, changing production methods etc.
- Genetic Resources - Animals, plants and microorganisms which are used for food and agriculture are called genetic resources.
- Known are currently 8,800 different breeds of birds and mammals within 38 species used for food and agriculture.



GENETIC DIVERSITY



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CARTEGENA PROTOCOL ON BIOSAFETY



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- Effective since 2003.
- Biosafety - It is the set of precautionary measures taken to safely contain potentially infectious agents and to prevent their exposure to humans and environment,
- Containment describes safety measures or properly managing infectious agent in the lab where they are being handled or maintained.
- The Cartagena Protocol on biosafety seeks to protect the biodiversity from the potential risks posed by GMOs.
- The Protocol allows the countries to ban the import of GMOs or their products if they feel that there is not enough scientific evidence that the product is safe. Also, it requires the exporters to label shipments properly containing GMOs or their products.



Learning Space

CARTEGENA PROTOCOL ON BIOSAFETY

- The protocol uses the Precautionary Principle. The Protocol promotes biosafety by establishing rules and procedures for the safe transfer, handling and use of LMOs with specific focus on trans-boundary movement of LMOs.
- The Advanced Informed Agreement (AIA) procedure applies to the first intentional trans-boundary movement of LMOs for introduction into the environment of the party of import.
- The purpose of this procedure is to ensure that importing countries have both the opportunity and capacity to assess risks that may be associated with LMO before agreeing to its import.



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